Rental properties - minimum standards

From 25 November 2025, rental properties must meet the minimum standards before they're advertised. From 1 December 2025, all rental properties must have secured cords on internal window coverings to prevent them forming loops. Read more below.

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- Renters' rights when the property does not meet minimum standards
- Minimum standards checklists for rental providers and renters
- Read the renting minimum standards

Find other language translations (https://www.consumer.vic.gov.au/resources-and-tools/other-languages) of this content in Arabic, Chinese Simplified, Chinese Traditional, Greek, Thai and Vietnamese.

Rental properties must meet the minimum standards

There are 15 categories of minimum standards for rental properties.

All rental properties must meet the standards for each category.

Rental providers (landlords) and agents must make sure a property meets minimum standards at the time they advertise or offer to let the property.

Rental providers must also make sure a property meets the minimum standards before the renter moves in.

Find more details about the 15 categories of minimum standards below.

Note: There are special rules for minimum standards in rooming houses (https://www.consumer.vic.gov.au/housing/renting/repairs-alterations-safety-and-pets/minimum-standards/rooming-house-minimum-standards).

When do minimum standards apply?

Rental properties must meet the minimum standards before they are advertised.

For existing rental agreements, the minimum standards, detailed in Schedule 4 of the Residential Tenancies Regulations 2021 (https://www.legislation.vic.gov.au/in-force/statutory-rules/residential-tenancies-regulations-2021/002), apply if your agreement started:

- on or after 29 March 2021, or
- before 29 March 2021 and became a periodic agreement (month to month) on or after 29 March 2021.

When do minimum standards not apply?

They don't apply if your rental agreement became a periodic agreement (month to month) before 29 March 2021.

Renters' rights when the property does not meet minimum standards

Find out about your rights as a renter if the property does not meet minimum standards (https://www.consumer.vic.gov.au/housing/renting/repairs-alterations-safety-and-pets/minimum-standards/renters-rights-when-minimum-standards-are-not-met), including where the rental provider fails to repair the property.

Minimum standards checklists for rental providers and renters

Rental providers

Learn more about the minimum standards and use our checklist before you move a renter into your rental property.

Download: (https://www.consumer.vic.gov.au/library/publications/housing-and-accommodation/renting/rental-minimum-standards/rental-minimum-standards-checklist-for-rental-providers-pdf.pdf) Rental minimum standards checklist for rental providers (https://www.consumer.vic.gov.au/library/publications/housing-and-accommodation/renting/rental-minimum-standards/rental-minimum-standards-checklist-for-rental-providers-pdf.pdf) (PDF, 160 KB)

Renters

Learn more about the minimum standards and use our checklist before you move into a new rental property.

Download: (https://www.consumer.vic.gov.au/library/publications/housing-and-accommodation/renting/rental-minimum-standards/rental-minimum-standards-checklist-for-renters-pdf.pdf) Rental minimum standards checklist for renters (https://www.consumer.vic.gov.au/library/publications/housing-and-accommodation/renting/rental-minimum-standards/rental-minimum-standards-checklist-for-renters-pdf.pdf) (PDF, 152 KB)

Read the renting minimum standards

New minimum rental standards for energy efficiency will come into effect from 1 March 2027. Read about what the new standards (https://www.consumer.vic.gov.au/resources-and-tools/legislation/public-consultations-and-reviews/new-minimum-energy-efficiency-standards) will mean for you.

+ Bathrooms
+ Electrical safety
+ Heating
+ Kitchen
+ Laundry
+ Lighting
+ Locks
+ Mould and damp
+ Structural soundness
+ Toilets
+ Ventilation
+ Vermin proof bins

+ Windows

+ Window coverings

+ Window covering anchors

Regulations

If you want to know what the law says about **minimum standards for rental properties**, read:

- Residential Tenancies Regulations 2021 Schedule 4 – Rental minimum standards (https://www.legislation.vic.gov.au/in-force/statutory-rules/residential-tenancies-regulations-2021)

For further detail on the **window covering anchors** requirements, read:

- Residential Tenancies Amendment (Housing Statement Reform and Part 4A Site Agreements) Regulations (https://www.legislation.vic.gov.au/as-made/statutory-rules/residential-tenancies-amendment-housing-statement-reform-and-part-4a-site-agreements-regulations)

Sections of the Act

If you want to know what the law says about minimum standards for rental properties, you can read these sections of the Residential Tenancies Act 1997 (https://www.legislation.vic.gov.au/in-force/acts/residential-tenancies-act-1997/104):

- Section 65A – Occupation of rented premises that do not comply with rental minimum standards
- Section 65B – Advertisement of premises for rent that do not comply with rental minimum standards
- Section 72 – Urgent repairs
- Section 77 – Payment of rent into Rent Special Account

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(https://www.consumer.vic.gov.au/resources-and-tools/yarrka-barring-resources-for-first-nations-people)

We acknowledge the Traditional Owners of the lands, seas and skies. We pay our respects to their Elders past and present, and to future generations who will continue to care for Country.

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